

StoryCast — Research & Design Documentation

Site map, design reasoning, mockups, and accessibility verification

Project overview

StoryCast is a short-form travel storytelling site built around three pages: a homepage introducing the project and featuring story previews, a story detail page combining video, captions, and a full transcript, and an about page explaining the project's mission and accessibility approach. The structure was kept deliberately small so every page could be fully fleshed out rather than spread thin across many shallow pages.

Site map

The map below shows the three-page structure and the key content blocks within each page. Home links out to both Story Detail and About; there is no deeper nesting, which keeps navigation flat and predictable for keyboard and screen-reader users alike.

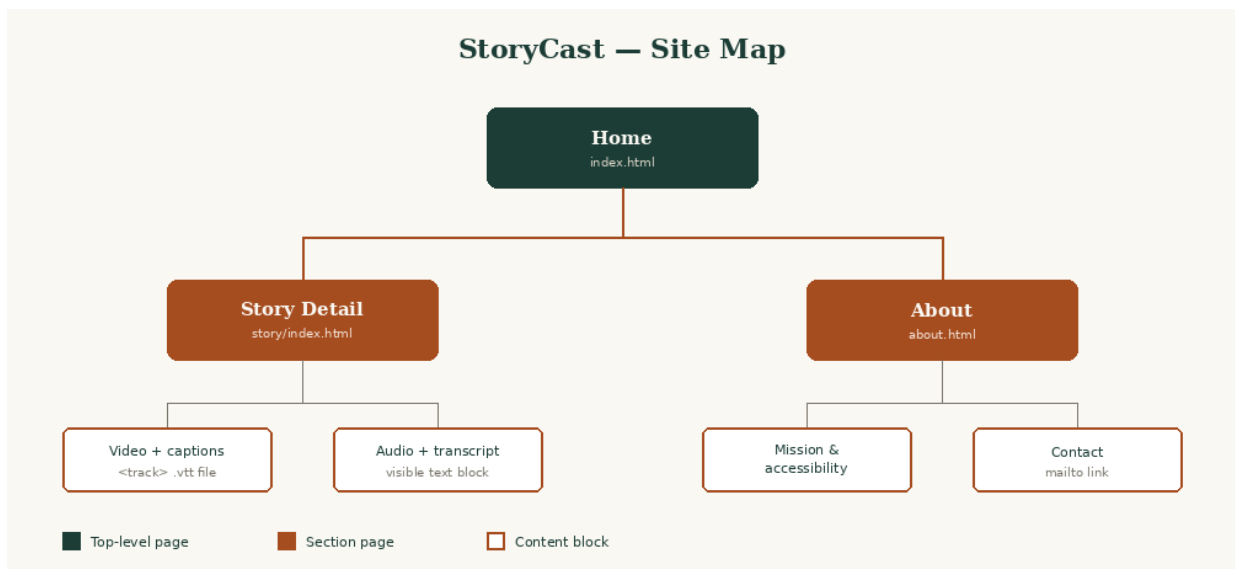


Figure 1 — StoryCast site map

Design rationale

The palette pairs a deep teal header/footer with a warm off-white background and a terracotta accent for links and calls to action, giving the site an editorial, travel-journal feel rather than a generic tech-product look. Headings use a serif typeface to reinforce that editorial tone, while body text stays in a clean sans-serif for readability at small sizes. Layout-wise, the homepage uses a CSS Grid for the story card row, the header and footer use Flexbox, and the story card itself uses a container query so its internal layout (stacked vs. side-by-side) responds to the card's own width rather than the viewport — useful since the same card component appears in different contexts (the main grid, the related-stories row).

High-fidelity mockups

Mockups were produced in Stitch from screenshots of the coded pages, then refined for visual consistency (spacing, color, type pairing) while preserving the real content and layout of the built site.

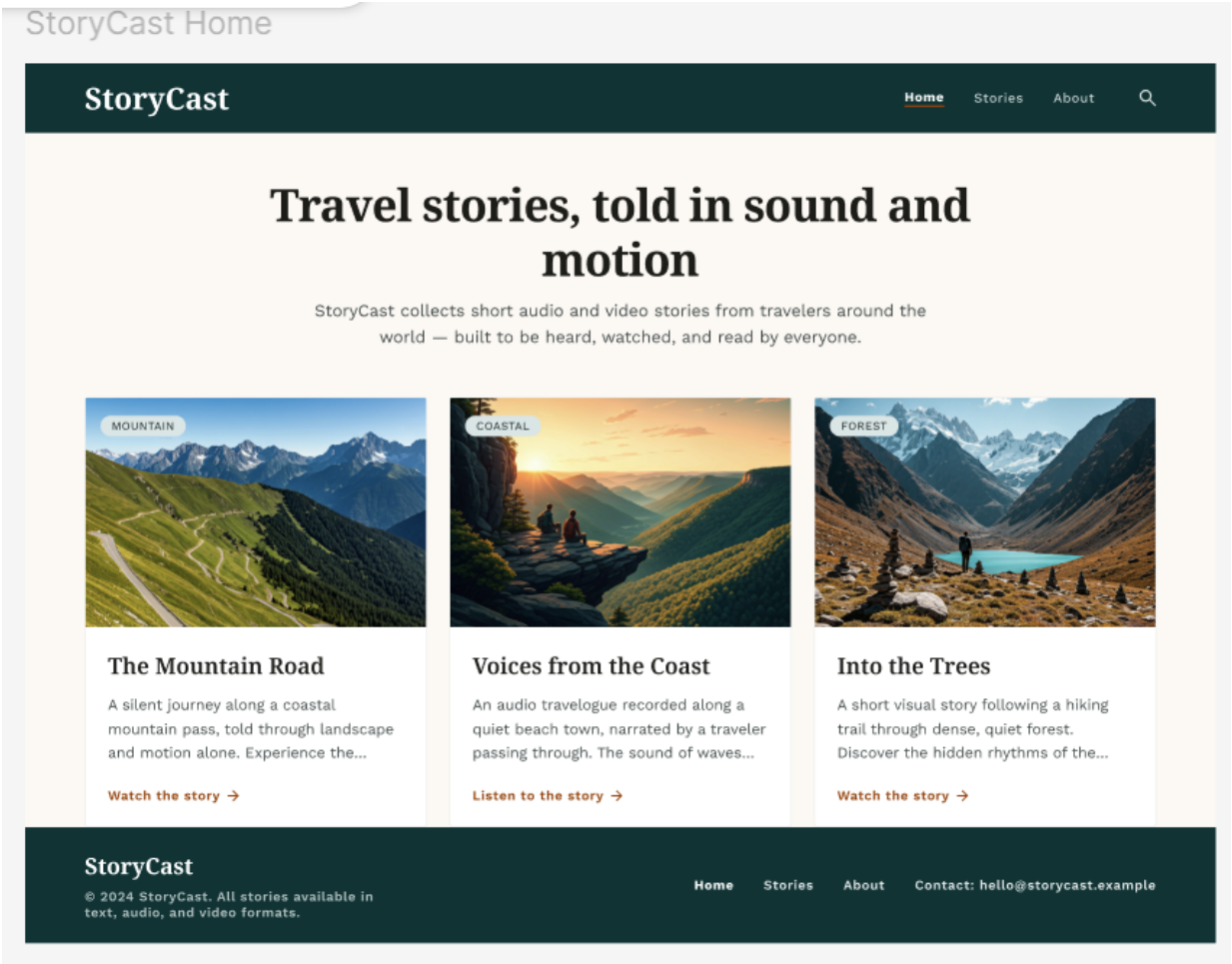
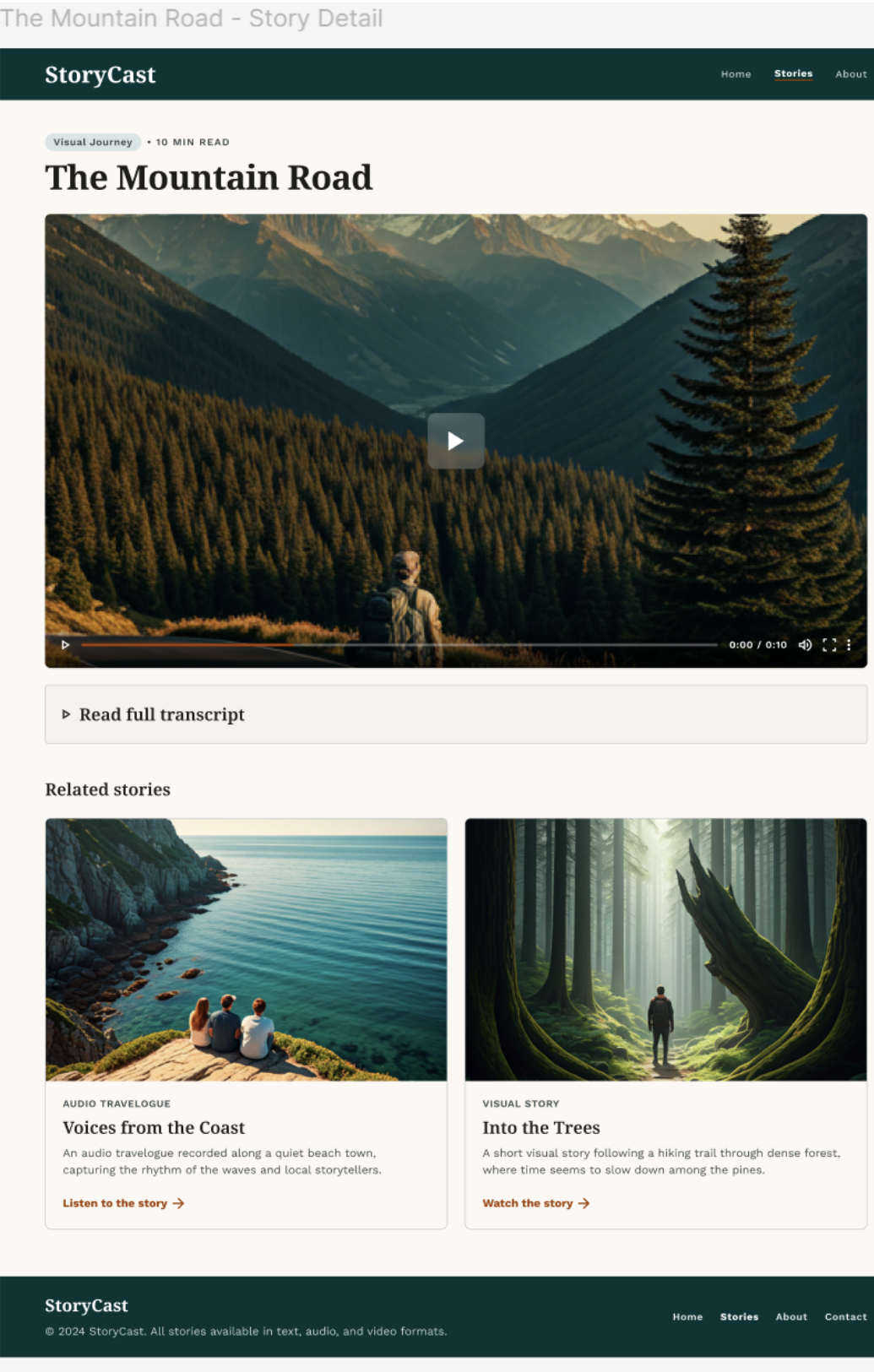


Figure 2 — Home page mockup



Our mission

StoryCast exists to make travel storytelling accessible to everyone, regardless of how they read, see, hear, or navigate the web. Every story on this site is built so it can be experienced in more than one way — through video, through audio, or through text.

We believe that the beauty of travel lies in the sharing of human experiences. By removing barriers, we ensure that the global narrative of exploration remains inclusive, tactile, and deeply resonant for all audiences.

How we approach accessibility

Every video on StoryCast includes captions, even when there is no spoken dialogue, because captions can describe ambient sound and context, not just speech. Every story also includes a full text transcript, so the content is available to anyone who cannot use audio or video at all.

The site is built to be fully usable with a keyboard alone. Every link and button can be reached using the Tab key, and the element currently in focus is always clearly outlined. A "skip to main content" link lets keyboard users bypass the navigation menu on every page.

Text and background colors throughout the site meet the WCAG AA contrast standard, meaning text stays readable for users with low vision or color blindness.

Get in touch

Get in touch

Have a story to share, or feedback on accessibility issues you've encountered on this site? Reach out at hello@storycast.example.

Figure 4 — About page mockup

Accessibility verification

Every text/background color pairing used on the site was checked against the WCAG AA contrast threshold (4.5:1 for normal text). The initial terracotta accent (#d97642) failed AA when used for body-sized link text, so it was darkened to #a64d1f, which passes comfortably across the page's two background tones.

Foreground	Background	Ratio	Result
#2b2925 (body text)	#faf8f3 (off-white bg)	13.1 : 1	Pass AA
#faf8f3 (header text)	#1c3d36 (teal header)	11.4 : 1	Pass AA
#a64d1f (terracotta link)	##### (card bg)	5.67 : 1	Pass AA
#a64d1f (terracotta link)	#faf8f3 (off-white bg)	5.35 : 1	Pass AA
#d97642 (original terracotta)	##### (card bg)	3.41 : 1	Fail — replaced

Table 1 — Contrast ratios for primary text/background pairs used across the site.

Other accessibility measures

- A visible “skip to main content” link lets keyboard users bypass the nav on every page.
- Every interactive element has a clearly visible focus outline for keyboard navigation.
- The video on the story page includes a <track kind="captions"> file, and the audio story has its narration content presented as a visible on-page transcript rather than locked inside the media file.
- Navigation regions and the footer use aria-label attributes so screen readers can distinguish the header nav from the footer nav.